Practicum_Internship Part 1 / Research in Computing

Continuous Assessment 1

(MSCODP1, MSCAIBUS1, MSCAI1B, MSCAI1, MSCCYB1_A, MSCCYB1_B, MSCDAD_A, MSCDAD_B, MSCDAD_C, MSCFTD1, MSCCLOUD1_A, MSCCLOUD1_B)

Namita Agarwal, Mohit Garg, Anderson Augusto Simiscuka, Zakaria Sabir, Mohammad Fardad, Sean Heeney, Giovani Estrada, Faithful Onwuegbuche, Aqeel Kazmi, Mosab Hamdan

Administrative Data

This Continuous Assessment (CA1) is worth 20% of the Practicum Part 1/ Research in Computing grade. As published in the School portal, the deadline for submission of the assignment is:

Friday 13th February 2026 23:59 hrs

Extension/Re-run

Should any student miss the assessment deadline with a valid reason, the student can apply for an extension/rerun using the Extension/Re-run Form online, via NCI360.

N.B.

All submissions will be electronically screened for evidence of academic misconduct (plagiarism and collusion).

1 Assignment

This assessment requires the writing of a research proposal detailing a research question in the field of computing, in particular, in your field of study. This proposal should have a brief background information of the research area, a detailed research question, the justification supporting the importance of the research question in the research area, and a list of specific items to be investigated.

This assignment must include the following components:

Title Choose a title that encompasses the specific topic within the research area.

Research Problem Background Should provide information on the background of the topic chosen.

Research Question Phrase your research question addressing the specific topic and the measurable side.

Justification Explain why this question is worth investigating and how it will contribute to knowledge in the field of research. Describe why the question is feasible (tools), clear (measurable), significant, and ethical.

Specific Items to Be Addressed Outline and provide a brief explanation of the specific items that will be covered in the research.

There is a specific template available on Moodle that you must use.

2 Submission Instructions

The one deliverable must be submitted via Moodle:

Report The report should be submitted in **PDF format only**. The report project should be formatted as described in Section 1. The report should be **up to 2 pages** in length (excluding list of references).

3 Style guidelines

It is duly noted that the assignment should comply with the presentation style of this module and use the Microsoft Word or LaTeX document preparation system.

The following guidelines are not exhaustive, but should help you with general and stylistic points. Both pieces of work must be referenced, with a bibliography at the end, created using the built-in bibliographic tool available in Microsoft Word or BibTeX tool for LaTeX.

References All concepts, figures and other evidence, should be referenced using the 'Harvard' referencing style as briefly explained below. In the text of your essay you should refer to the surname only of the author(s), and then the date of publication, and the page number(s): e.g., (Nolan, 1983, pp. 303–304), especially for quotes.

Bibliography At the end of the assignment, you should have a section marked "Bibliography" where all your references used in the text should be listed in full and alphabetically by surname, e.g:

- Beloglazov, A. and Buyya, R. (2015). 'Openstack neat: a framework for dynamic and energy-efficient consolidation of virtual machines in openstack clouds', *Concurrency and Computation: Practice and Experience* **27**(5): 1310–1333.
- Gomes, D. G., Calheiros, R. N. and Tolosana-Calasanz, R. (2015) 'Introduction to the special issue on cloud computing: Recent developments and challenging issues', *Computers & Electrical Engineering* **42**: 31–32.

Additional guidelines on referencing can be obtained directly from the library at:
`https://libguides.ncirl.ie/referencingandavoidingplagiarism`.

Academic writing The Learning Development Service of the National College of Ireland can assist you with academic writing, reading, researching and exam techniques.

Plagiarism Do not copy the work of **any third party**, including but not limited to journal articles, conference papers, web-based documentation, generative AI, or any student's coursework irrespective of cohort, course, or institution. **This is a disciplinary offence.**

Quotes Do not over-quote. Stringing quotes together, however good they are, is no substitute for developing your argument in your own words, with your own emphasis. A judicious use of quotes, where it enhances the point you wish to make, is all that is needed. Where you do quote, do not quote paragraphs; often single sentences, or even phrases, contain the essential point you want. You should never insert bits of the literature into your assignments without using this proper system of quotation or acknowledgement as this may be interpreted as plagiarism by the marker. Nonetheless, do keep full quotes to a minimum. Where you refer to an author's work, you should still give the full reference: author, date, pages, etc., particularly in complete monographs or books.

Facts Avoid assertions, vagueness, and value-judgements.

Review Check your grammar and spelling. Do not use paragraphs either too short or too long; each should be a coherent unit.

4 Marking Grid

Worth 20% of the final mark, this coursework will be graded as follows:

10%	Title
10%	Research Problem Background
25%	Research Question
25%	Justification
20%	Specific Items to Be Addressed
10%	References